Joining the forest coops (森林組合 加入): preparation sheet

Internal note for Rob. Covers the Mitsue coop (御杖村森林組合) and the Uda coop (宇陀市森林組合). **Nothing here has been sent or submitted.** Coop rules are set by each coop's bylaws (定款); the general rules below come from the Forestry Cooperative Act (森林組合法) and other coops' public pages, so every figure and form must be confirmed with each coop.

1. What membership means (general rules)

- **正組合員 (regular member):** an individual who owns forest inside the coop's district (some bylaws set a minimum area, e.g. 10 a), or lives there and works in forestry. Votes and elects officers.
- **准組合員 (associate member):** for people who don't qualify as regular members, if the bylaws allow it. **No vote or election rights.**
- **How to join:** a 加入申込書 with address, name and the number of share units (出資口数; in other coops one unit is often ¥100 to ¥1,000), plus proof of forest ownership if requested (登記事項, 固定資産税の課税明細). A yearly levy (賦課金) may also apply. Shares are returned on leaving only as the bylaws allow.
- **Membership does not give you a say in bids or work orders.** It gives you information, a vote at the general meeting (正組合員), and standing as a landowner.

2. Your land: confirm first

- **Sugano 616-1 and 616-2 (菅野, Mitsue):** the registry request is pending (service closed on 2026-10-29; retry next morning).
- **What we need from the registry:** the current 地目, 面積, and the owner's name and share. The 2013 sale note lists both lots as 山林 (forest). **If the 地目 has changed to 宅地 or 畑, it does not count as forest**, so regular membership through it may not be possible.
- Fill this in once the PDF arrives:

Item	Lot 616-1	Lot 616-2
地目	山林 (per 2013 sale note)	山林 (per 2013 sale note)
面積, registry (公簿)	B区 23 m2	C区 112 m2
面積, measured (実測)	B区 221.29 m2	C区 569.21 m2 (total 790.50 m2)
所有者 (name as registered)	to confirm: you personally (YR-DESIGN is a trade name, not a company)? Co-owned with someone?	same
森林経営計画 / 伐採届 status		

Source for the known rows: 取引に関する御説明 dated 2013-03-25 from 株式会社ロビンウッド (purchase price ¥1,500,000; registration by 米田司法書士事務所, 0745-92-3168). It is the seller's explanation, not the registry, so confirm each row against tomorrow's registry copy. **Check two things:** (1) the registered owner: YR-DESIGN is a trade name, not a company, so the owner should be you personally; if the land is co-owned (for example with your partner), ask the coop how a co-owned lot is treated, since only one person can be the member for it; (2) the registry area is only about 135 m2 (measured 790.5 m2), which may fall below a coop's minimum area if it has one.

3. Details usually asked on the form (have ready)

- Name as in the registry (the account name was entered as ロブ ファン・アウデンダイク; match your 住民票 and 登記 spelling exactly); address; date of birth; phone; email.
- Forest land: location (大字・地番), 地目, area, how acquired.
- Share units to subscribe; seal (印鑑) or signature as the coop requires.
- Proof of ownership (registry copy), and ID if asked.

4. Mitsue coop (御杖村森林組合)

- **Contact:** 〒633-1301 御杖村神末798 (間伐材加工センター内), 0745-95-2010, info@mitsuemori.com. Its website says it is being renewed.
- **Context:** on 2026-10-27 the coop ended the relationship with the project. Membership as a **landowner** is a separate matter, but expect it to be read in that light.
- **Your decision first:** do you want to be a member now, or wait? Consider that members receive coop mail and vote at the general meeting.
- **Ask the coop:** eligibility for your lots; unit price and number of units; yearly levy; documents; who is the right contact; whether the board must approve new members.

5. Uda coop (宇陀市森林組合)

- **Contact:** 0745-82-1409, fax 0745-82-7543, 〒633-0218 宇陀市榛原桧牧1026; weekdays 8:30-17:30. Your form message and email (2026-10-29) are still unanswered.
- **District:** Uda City only. Your forest is in Mitsue, so a regular membership is unlikely. **Ask whether they take associate members** (准組合員) and on what terms.
- **Caution:** don't offer membership as a favour or as leverage. Use it only if the coop proposes it, and keep it separate from the site discussion.
- **Ask the coop:** whether non-owners or outside-district people can join; the cost; what members receive (newsletter, general meeting, information); the process and timing.

6. Phone lines (Japanese)

- 「組合員加入について教えていただきたく、お電話しました。」
- 「御杖村に森林があるのですが、どのような条件で加入できますか。」(Uda: 「地区外ですが、准組合員として加入できますか。」)
- 「出資の口数と金額、年間の賦課金、必要な書類を教えてください。」
- 「加入申込書はどちらでいただけますか。」

7. Next steps

1. Get the Sugano 616-1/616-2 registry (tomorrow) and fill section 2.
2. Decide whether to join the Mitsue coop now or later.
3. Call the Uda coop (with the membership question, after your visit request has been answered).
4. Prepare the application from section 3 once you have each coop's own form.

Sources: Forestry Cooperative Act (森林組合法) https://www.shugiin.go.jp/internet/itdb_housei.nsf/html/houritsu/08419780501036.htm ; MAFF model bylaws https://www.rinya.maff.go.jp/j/keiei/kumiai/attach/pdf/index-41.pdf ; examples of other coops' joining pages (JA Hida, Karasugawa, Okayama).